LVNA
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VILLAGER

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- Lakewood Park Tree Walk -



Tree #4: Saucer Magnolia

In April, we highlighted Tree #1, the London Plane tree. From there, Tree #2 was the Italian Stone Pine, visible from the same spot as Tree #1. We then walked northeast, stopping at a concrete bench on your left for Tree #3, the Crape Myrtle. The fourth tree on SUFA (Sunnyvale Urban Forest Advocates) Lakewood Park Tree Walk is the Saucer Magnolia.

By this point, you should be mostly at Lakechime Drive, having approached it from the south. If you look to your

right, you should see the playground. Just outside the playground fence will be a medium height, skinny tree, which is our Tree #4, the Saucer Magnolia.

The Saucer Magnolia gets its name from its flowers, which are large and (at least according to Google, saucer-shaped). The tree blooms in early spring, with pink flowers that appear before the leaves do, and it is common in both the USA and the British Isles. In fact, it's one of the most popular horticulture magnolias and, unlike other magnolias, the saucer magnolia is relatively tolerant to both alkaline* soils and wind.

Its Latin name is Magnolia × soulangeana, and the tree was bred in France in 1820 by a retired cavalry officer from Napoleon's army, Étienne Soulange-Bodin. Monsieur Soulange-Bodin was well-known for his work establishing professional horticulture in France in the early 1800s. The genus is named after Magnus von Lagerström. A Swedish merchant and director of the Swedish East India Company, he sent many plants to Carl Linnaeus (who is known as the father of modern taxonomy).

Want to plant one in your yard? Plant it in full sun or partial shade (preferably full sun). The saucer magnolia likes rich, well-draining soil - although, once established, it is reasonably drought tolerant.

*What's "alkaline"? It comes from the pH scale. A pH of 7 is neutral. pH of less than 7 is acidic, and a pH of more than 7 is basic. An alkaline substance has a pH of more than 7, meaning it is more basic than neutral. You may have heard arguments that alkaline water is better than plain tap water because alkaline water can neutralize acid in the bloodstream. (Whether or not this is true is something to research after your tree walk.) Alkaline soil is called "sweet soil". It has a lot of magnesium, sodium, and calcium. It is also less water soluble than acidic or neutral soil, which means that it's more difficult for plants in alkaline soil to access the soil nutrients. Plants growing in alkaline soil are often nutrient deficient and have reduced growth.

Want to learn more? Check out these links:

- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Magnolia_%C3%97_soulangeana
- https://www.thespruce.com/magnolia-trees-saucer-magnolias-2132135
- https://www.arborday.org/trees/treeguide/treedetail.cfm?itemID=862
- https://www.gardeningknowhow.com/garden-how-to/soil-fertilizers/alkaline-soil-plants.htm

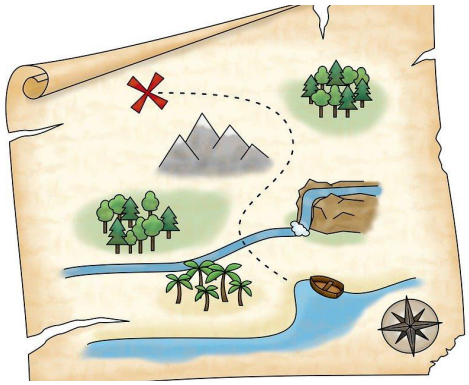
As a reminder, the tree walk maps can be found here:

- (http://www.sunnyvaletrees.org/tree-walk-maps/), and the tree guides here (http://www.sunnyvaletrees.org/tree-guide/).

Courtesy to Sunnyvale Forest Advocates (SUFA) for allowing us to reproduce their website content in our Villager. For more information, see their website at http://www.sunnyvaletrees.org/

- Neighborhood Scavenger Hunt -

Congratulations to Marley K on the Fairwood Side, who was the winner of the July scavenger hunt for guessing all of the answers correctly! Marley received a $10 gift card as a prize.



Welcome to the monthly scavenger hunt! Send your name, address (to confirm that you live in the Lakewood/Fairwood neighborhood), and answers to the three questions to vp1@lvnasv.org by August 31, and we will announce the winner and the correct answers in the next newsletter. If there is a tie for the winner, we will randomly select one person as the winner. ***The winner will get to choose a $10 gift card from World Wrapps, Wal-Mart, or Giovanni's Pizzeria.***

For this month's scavenger hunt, we are going to look for things on the LVNA website. Go to www.lvnasv.org to start.

1. Which of these roads is the closest to Hwy 101?
    a. Pecos Way
    b. Lakechime Dr
    c. Wildwood Ave
2. True/False: The John W Christian Greenbelt only runs through the Fairwood side of the neighborhood.
    a. True.
    b. False.
3. What is the name of the mobile home park that is west of Lakewood neighborhood?
    a. El Dorado Mobile Home Park
    b. Plaza del Rey
    c. Casa de Amigos Mobile Park

Answers from the June scavenger hunt:

1. Which of the following dates is NOT the date of an upcoming LVNA Monthly Meeting? *ANSWER: (b) Sept 8*
2. True/False: The email addresses for the LVNA board members end in "lvnasv.org". *ANSWER: (a) True*
3. The LVNA website has links to many of our previous Villagers. Which of these Villager issues are available on the LVNA website? *ANSWER: (d) All of the above*

- Reminders -

Little Free Puzzle Library

As a reminder, the Little Free Puzzle Library has found a new home! Please come by to take a few puzzles or drop some off. As a gentle reminder, this is a resource for the entire community. Please take no more than 3 puzzles at a time. While it's not required to return the puzzles when you are done, returning them will help keep the Puzzle Library well stocked. For location information, please email vp1@lvnasv.org

Library of Things

For those who want to travel farther, the Sunnyvale Public Library also has a Library of Things, where you can borrow Chromebooks, Kill-A-Watt meters, Nintendo Switch games, jigsaw puzzles, and other items. Check out their recent article on Page 2 of the Summer 2022 edition of the Sunnyvale Horizon here: https://www.sunnyvale.ca.gov/home/showpublisheddocument/3570/637920840156570000

LVNA CONTACTS

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IMPORTANT NUMBERS

Emergency	911
Abandoned Vehicles	(408) 730-7150
Shopping Carts & Graffiti	(408) 730-7680
Animal Control	(408) 730-7178
Neighborhood Preservation	(408) 730-7610
Parks & Maintenance	(408) 730-7506
Public Safety - Info	(408) 730-7100
Public Safety - Non-Emergency	(408) 730-7180

LVNA Meeting Recap

LVNA Meeting in July

The July meeting was canceled.

Upcoming Events

August

10 LVNA Monthly Meeting

We're having Helping Hands present at our meeting, whose mission is to support those who lack access to the basic needs of food/shetler, and assist them in moving towards self sufficiency.

September

14 LVNA Monthly Meeting

Find us on Nextdoor!

If you have not already joined the LVNA group on Nextdoor then we encourage you to do so. Nextdoor allows separate settings for group posts so it's an excellent way to get curated Lakewood Village-relevant content while filtering out the rest. Board members post reminders about upcoming events and moderators ensure all activity in the group adheres to the group's rules (e.g., content relevant to Lakewood Village, no soliciting, etc.). Note that only Lakewood Village residents are permitted to join.

To learn more or to join, visit nextdoor.com/g/alya6yxap